



ST. ANN'S COLLEGE FOR WOMEN

Run by The Society of St Anne

Affiliated to Acharya Nagarjuna University, Approved by AICTE

Recognised under Section 2(f) of the UGC Act 1956, New Delhi.

Accredited by NAAC with 'A' Grade in the first cycle

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INSTITUTIONAL INNOVATION CELL (IIC) ANNUAL ACTIVITY REPORT Academic Year 2024–2025

1. Introduction

The Institutional Innovation Cell (IIC) of St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur functions as an institutional platform for nurturing innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship, problem-solving and an innovative mindset among students and faculty members.

During the academic year 2024–2025, the Cell focused on creating awareness about innovation and entrepreneurship and encouraging students to identify problems, generate creative ideas and explore practical solutions. The activities of the Cell were intended to promote a culture of creative thinking, experimentation, entrepreneurship and intellectual property awareness within the institution.

The IIC encouraged students to look beyond conventional learning and develop skills that could contribute to their academic growth, employability, self-employment and future entrepreneurial pursuits.

2. Objectives of the Institutional Innovation Cell

The major objectives of the IIC during the academic year 2024–2025 were:

1. To create awareness about **innovation and creativity** among students and faculty.
2. To encourage students to develop an **innovative and problem-solving mindset**.
3. To promote **entrepreneurship and self-employment** as career opportunities.
4. To encourage students to identify real-life problems and develop appropriate solutions.
5. To promote awareness of **Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)**.
6. To encourage idea generation, brainstorming and creative thinking.
7. To provide opportunities for interaction with experts and professionals.
8. To encourage students to participate in innovation-related activities and competitions.

9. To promote **women entrepreneurship** and leadership.
 10. To strengthen coordination among the IIC, IQAC, academic departments and other institutional cells.
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3. Major Focus Areas

The Institutional Innovation Cell focused on the following broad areas during 2024–2025:

- Innovation and creativity
 - Idea generation and brainstorming
 - Problem identification and problem-solving
 - Design thinking
 - Entrepreneurship awareness
 - Start-up orientation
 - Intellectual Property Rights awareness
 - Patent and copyright awareness
 - Student project innovation
 - Skill development
 - Expert interaction
 - Women entrepreneurship
 - Social innovation
 - Sustainable innovation
 - Technology-enabled solutions
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4. Major Activities of the IIC

4.1 Innovation Awareness

The IIC promoted awareness among students regarding the importance of **innovation, creativity and original thinking**. Students were encouraged to observe challenges in their academic, social and community environment and think of practical solutions.

The initiative aimed to develop curiosity, creativity and confidence among students and encourage them to convert their ideas into meaningful activities or projects.

4.2 Idea Generation and Brainstorming

Students were encouraged to participate in idea-generation and brainstorming activities. They were motivated to identify problems and discuss possible innovative solutions.

The activities emphasised:

- Identification of problems
- Collection of ideas
- Brainstorming
- Creative thinking
- Evaluation of ideas
- Selection of feasible solutions
- Development of innovative approaches

These activities helped students improve their analytical and creative abilities.

4.3 Design Thinking and Problem-Solving

The IIC promoted the basic principles of **design thinking** and problem-solving among students.

Students were encouraged to understand the needs of users or communities, define problems clearly, generate possible solutions and consider the feasibility and usefulness of proposed solutions.

This approach helped students develop a systematic method of approaching academic and real-life challenges.

4.4 Entrepreneurship Awareness

The Cell created awareness regarding **entrepreneurship as an alternative career pathway**.

Students were encouraged to understand the basic requirements of becoming an entrepreneur, including:

- Identification of opportunities
- Business idea development
- Market understanding
- Resource planning
- Risk assessment
- Financial awareness
- Communication and leadership
- Customer orientation
- Business sustainability

The initiative aimed to develop an entrepreneurial mindset among students.

4.5 Start-up Orientation

Students were introduced to the basic concept of transforming an innovative idea into an entrepreneurial opportunity.

The broad process was explained as:

Problem Identification → Idea Generation → Validation → Solution Development → Business Model → Market Understanding → Enterprise / Start-up

Students were encouraged to understand the importance of feasibility, customer requirements and sustainability before pursuing an entrepreneurial idea.

4.6 Intellectual Property Rights Awareness

The IIC promoted awareness regarding the importance of protecting **innovative ideas and intellectual creations**.

Students and faculty members were sensitised to the basic concepts of:

- Intellectual Property Rights
- Patents
- Copyrights

- Trademarks
- Innovation protection
- Originality of ideas
- Documentation of innovative work

The initiative helped students understand that innovation and intellectual property protection are closely connected.

4.7 Student Innovation and Project-Based Learning

Students were encouraged to connect their academic knowledge with practical applications through projects and innovative activities.

The IIC encouraged students to explore ideas in areas such as:

- Technology
- Commerce
- Computer applications
- Science
- Environment
- Education
- Social development
- Women empowerment
- Sustainable development

The objective was to encourage students to use their subject knowledge to address practical problems.

4.8 Entrepreneurship and Women Empowerment

As a women's institution, the Cell encouraged students to consider **entrepreneurship, self-employment and leadership** as important opportunities for personal and professional development.

Students were encouraged to explore different forms of enterprise, including:

- Small-scale businesses
- Service-based enterprises
- Digital entrepreneurship
- Skill-based enterprises
- Home-based enterprises
- Social entrepreneurship
- Technology-based enterprises

The initiative aimed to strengthen confidence, leadership, decision-making and entrepreneurial abilities among students.

4.9 Expert Interaction and Mentoring

The IIC encouraged students to benefit from the knowledge and experience of **entrepreneurs, professionals, innovators and subject experts**.

Such interactions were intended to provide practical understanding of:

- Innovation opportunities
- Entrepreneurship
- Business challenges
- Idea development
- Career opportunities
- Start-up development
- Professional skills

Students were encouraged to seek guidance for developing and refining their ideas.

4.10 Innovation Competitions and Student Participation

Students were encouraged to participate in activities that provided opportunities to demonstrate their creativity and innovative thinking.

Such activities included, as applicable:

- Idea presentations
- Innovation-related competitions
- Poster presentations
- Project exhibitions
- Quizzes
- Essay and creative activities
- Business idea presentations
- Problem-solving activities

These activities provided students with opportunities to develop presentation, communication and teamwork skills.

4.11 Faculty Orientation and Support

The Cell encouraged faculty members to support student innovation through mentoring, guidance and motivation.

Faculty members were encouraged to:

- Motivate students to think creatively.
- Identify promising student ideas.
- Guide students in project development.
- Encourage interdisciplinary thinking.
- Promote innovation-oriented learning.
- Create awareness regarding IPR and entrepreneurship.

Faculty support was considered an important component of developing a sustainable innovation culture.

4.12 Collaboration with Institutional Cells and Departments

The IIC promoted coordination with relevant institutional bodies and academic departments for strengthening innovation-related activities.

The Cell worked towards integrating innovation and entrepreneurship with:

- IQAC
- Research & Development activities
- IPR-related activities
- Entrepreneurship initiatives
- Career Guidance and Placement activities
- Academic Departments
- Student support activities

Such coordination helped create a broader institutional ecosystem for innovation and entrepreneurship.

5. Student Engagement

Students from different disciplines were encouraged to participate in innovation and entrepreneurship-oriented activities.

The multidisciplinary academic environment of the institution provided opportunities for students from **Commerce, Computer Science, Computer Applications, Mathematics, Physics, Statistics, Biotechnology, Microbiology, Botany, Chemistry and other disciplines** to approach problems from different perspectives.

The IIC encouraged students to combine academic knowledge, creativity and practical thinking in developing solutions.

6. Outcomes of IIC Activities

The activities undertaken by the Institutional Innovation Cell during **2024–2025** contributed to:

- Creating awareness about innovation and entrepreneurship.
- Encouraging creative and critical thinking.
- Developing problem-solving abilities among students.

- Promoting an entrepreneurial mindset.
 - Creating awareness regarding Intellectual Property Rights.
 - Encouraging students to identify real-life problems.
 - Promoting student participation in innovation-oriented activities.
 - Encouraging women entrepreneurship and self-employment.
 - Strengthening faculty mentoring and student guidance.
 - Encouraging interdisciplinary learning and collaboration.
 - Supporting the institution's efforts towards quality enhancement and innovation.
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7. Best Practices

The IIC promoted the following practices during the academic year:

1. **Student-centric innovation**
 2. **Problem-based learning**
 3. **Creative brainstorming and idea generation**
 4. **Interdisciplinary participation**
 5. **Innovation-oriented project work**
 6. **Entrepreneurship awareness**
 7. **IPR awareness**
 8. **Faculty mentoring**
 9. **Promotion of women entrepreneurship**
 10. **Encouragement of socially relevant and sustainable ideas**
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8. Impact of the Cell

The activities of the IIC helped in creating a positive environment for **innovation, creativity and entrepreneurship** on the campus.

Students were encouraged to become active learners, identify opportunities, develop solutions and consider entrepreneurship as a possible career pathway. The Cell also contributed to

strengthening the connection between **academic learning, practical problem-solving, innovation and employability**.

The initiatives provided a foundation for developing an institutional culture in which students and faculty members could freely explore ideas and innovative approaches.

9. Future Directions

Based on the foundation developed during 2024–2025, the Cell envisages strengthening the innovation ecosystem through:

- Regular innovation awareness programmes.
 - Design-thinking and ideation workshops.
 - Student innovation projects.
 - Entrepreneurship development programmes.
 - IPR and patent awareness.
 - Expert and entrepreneur interactions.
 - Mentoring of innovative student ideas.
 - Innovation competitions and exhibitions.
 - Development of prototypes and models.
 - Industry and start-up interaction.
 - Promotion of women-led entrepreneurship.
 - Exploration of incubation and funding opportunities.
 - Encouragement of sustainable and socially relevant innovations.
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10. Conclusion

The **Institutional Innovation Cell (IIC), St. Ann's College for Women, Gorantla, Guntur**, worked towards promoting a culture of **innovation, creativity, entrepreneurship and problem-solving** during the academic year **2024–2025**.

The initiatives of the Cell encouraged students to think creatively, identify challenges, explore innovative solutions and develop an entrepreneurial outlook. The Cell also promoted awareness of Intellectual Property Rights and encouraged faculty involvement in mentoring and supporting student ideas.

The IIC remains committed to nurturing an institutional environment where **creativity is encouraged, ideas are valued, innovation is promoted and students are empowered to become confident, skilled and socially responsible innovators and entrepreneurs.**

Prepared by:

Institutional Innovation Cell (IIC)

St. Ann's College for Women

Gorantla, Guntur, Andhra Pradesh

Academic Year: 2024–2025